



Day 03/55 - Install Python

Windows local development setup

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Video Summary

This lesson walks beginners through setting up Python locally on a Windows machine. It covers checking whether Python is already installed, downloading the official installer, selecting the PATH option, reopening the terminal, and running both interactive commands and saved .py files.

Core ideas from the lesson



Verify

Check `python --version` or `python3 --version` before installing.



Download

Use the official Python website for the latest stable Windows installer.



PATH

Select Add python.exe to PATH during setup to avoid manual fixes.



Run Code

Use the Python prompt for quick tests and .py files for scripts.

1

Before You Install

Start by checking whether Python is already available on your computer. Open Command Prompt, PowerShell, or Windows Terminal and run a version command. If a version number appears, Python is installed. If Windows cannot find Python, continue with the official installer.

terminal check

```
python --version
python3 --version
```

Why this check matters

It saves time and avoids duplicate installs. Confirm first, then install only when needed.

Check



Download



Install



Reopen

A fresh terminal session is needed after installation so PATH changes are loaded.

Beginner takeaway

Verify first, install from python.org, reopen the terminal, then run scripts.

2 Download Python Safely

Visit the official Python website and download the current stable Windows installer. The lesson emphasizes using the official source so beginners avoid unsafe downloads and get the standard installer experience.

Official download page

<https://www.python.org/downloads/>

3 Install With PATH Selected

During installation, the most important beginner-friendly step is selecting the PATH option on the first installer screen.

Installer checklist

- ☒ Download the Windows installer.
- ☒ Check Add python.exe to PATH.
- ☒ Choose Install Now.
- ☒ Wait for setup to complete.

Important

Add python.exe to PATH

This makes the python command available from any terminal folder. Without it, beginners often need manual PATH configuration later.

After setup: close and reopen the terminal

A terminal that was already open will not automatically know about the new PATH setting. Close it, open a new one, and verify again.

Command	What it checks	Expected result
<code>python --version</code>	Confirms Python is reachable from PATH.	A Python version number is printed.
<code>python</code>	Starts the interactive Python prompt.	A <code>>>></code> prompt appears for quick commands.
<code>exit()</code>	Leaves the Python prompt.	You return to the normal terminal.

Learning mindset

The PATH checkbox keeps the first local setup smooth and lets you focus on code.

4

Run Code in the Terminal

For quick practice, type python in the terminal to open the Python prompt. This is useful for testing small commands immediately without creating a file.

```
interactive prompt
python
>>> print("Hello World")
Hello World
```

5

Save and Run a Python File

For longer programs, write code in a text editor such as Notepad and save the file with a .py extension. The extension matters because it tells tools and IDEs that the file contains Python code.

demo.py

```
print("Hello World")
```

Run from terminal

```
python demo.py
```

Beginner issue	Why it happens	Simple fix
File saved as .txt	Notepad may add .txt if the name is not saved carefully.	Save as demo.py and choose all files if needed.
python not recognized	The PATH setting is missing or terminal was not reopened.	Reinstall with PATH checked or reopen terminal.
Wrong folder	Terminal is running from a different directory.	Move to the file folder, then run python demo.py.



Day 03/55 takeaway
Verify Python, open the prompt, save .py files, and run scripts from the terminal.